The Well-Tempered clAIvier

IX. Fugue in E major (a 4): Ricercar in circulo

Keyboard - four voices (four singers in a ring)

Original composition (Claude) for Sam; guest subject J. S. Bach, BWV 878 (after J. C. F. Fischer)




Antiphony: left half (S A)
right half (T B)
Antiphony L1: subject (A), soprano; left half alone
Antiphony R1: guest, BWV 878 subject at Bach's pitch (E), bass; right half alone
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R
Antiphony L3: head (A), soprano
Antiphony L2: head of the subject (B), alto
Antiphony R2: head of the guest (c#), bass
Antiphony R3: head of the guest (f#), bass
Final tutti: the guest as cantus
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Guest as cantus: BWV 878 subject in augmentation (x2), soprano (its last E5 is b54.1)
Final stretto 1: subject (on E), alto, front left
Antiphony L4: rising fourth (head), alto
Final stretto 2: subject (E), tenor, front right, half a bar later
Antiphony R4: the guest's 1-2-4, tenor
Final stretto 3: subject (E), bass, back right, at its exposition pitch
Coda: the cantus turns into the subject
Coda: subject (on E), soprano: the cantus's last note becomes the subject's first